Alexander Key

Senior Full-Stack Rails Developer

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Experience

Eyecall Marketing Inc. — Austin, TX **2016 – Present**

Parent company that owns and operates four Ruby on Rails software businesses: Reservation Genie (tour and charter reservations), 88 Restaurants (restaurant management), Tally Meals (Greek house meal management), and Austin City Guide (a high-traffic city guide and CMS). Joined in 2016 and have since architected, rebuilt, and operated all four Rails codebases, from schema design and payments to production servers and deployment.

Senior Software Engineer 2020 – Present
Software Engineer 2016 – 2020

Reservation Genie **2016 – Present**

- Rebuilt a legacy Rails 3 reservation platform from greenfield on Ruby on Rails 8, PostgreSQL, and Hotwire, leading a small team to deliver reservations, rentals, private charters, and digital waivers at 50,000+ reservations a year.
- Built the payment system behind every booking on the Stripe API (charges, webhooks, refunds) plus an ActiveMerchant gateway layer that lets clients bring their own payment processor, processing ~$5M a year in payment volume.
- Increased client reservations 20% by launching white-labeled booking subdomains (e.g. book.clientdomain.com) with host-aware routing and cookie scoping, so UTM and Google Ads attribution survives from the client's site through purchase and clients can see which channels convert.

88 Restaurants **2021 – Present**

- Split the restaurant product out of the shared Reservation Genie codebase into a greenfield multi-tenant platform spanning online ordering, reservations, live table management, loyalty, and marketing automation: 4,400+ commits across 280K lines of application code, a 140-table MySQL schema, and a 615-file RSpec suite, owning the stack from schema design to production servers.
- Processed 8 figures in payment volume by architecting the online ordering system end to end: Stripe checkout and refunds, Uber Direct delivery integration, order scheduling, gift cards, and a full catering system.
- Built live table management with real-time table-state synchronization across every device in the restaurant over ActionCable WebSockets, a drag-and-drop floor-plan editor, and an availability engine, giving front-of-house staff a single live view of the floor.

Tally Meals **2025 – Present**

- Replaced a failing legacy PHP API and React Native platform for Greek house meal management by leading a small team through a ground-up Ruby on Rails rebuild, now serving 100+ houses across 35+ universities.
- Shipped iOS and Android apps from a single Rails codebase using Hotwire Native, letting members reserve meals and late plates against chef-published menus with per-member allergy and dietary tracking, meal-plan limits, and printable kitchen prep lists.
- Carried every client's historical data through the replatform by converting the legacy database to PostgreSQL, reverse-engineering the old schema and migrating chapters, members, meal plans, and reservation history into the new Rails domain model.

Austin City Guide **2020 – 2022**

- Achieved #1 Google rankings for competitive local keywords like "things to do in Austin" through on-page SEO, technical optimization, and page-speed work after rebuilding the decade-old .NET site from the ground up in Ruby on Rails.
- Built in-house analytics in Rails to measure real user behavior across the site's highest-traffic pages.
- Increased click-through rates on the highest-traffic pages with an A/B split-testing system in Rails that tested page layouts against live traffic.

Education

Bachelor of Science, Computer Science — Texas State University, San Marcos, TX

Skills

Back End: Ruby, Ruby on Rails (3 – 8), Active Record, Active Job, ActionCable, Action Mailer, Active Merchant, Stripe, RSpec, Sidekiq, PostgreSQL, MySQL, Redis, REST APIs, Twilio, Postmark, Uber Direct

Front End: Hotwire (Turbo & Stimulus), Hotwire Native (iOS & Android), JavaScript, TailwindCSS, Bootstrap

Infrastructure: Linux, Kamal, Dokku, Nginx, GitHub Actions